



AUSSIE PRIMARY ACADEMY

YEAR 3 SPRING SCHOOL HOLIDAY LEARNING PACK



5 DAYS | 15-20 MINUTES A DAY

English | Maths | Spring Challenge | Answer Key

Keep skills fresh and feel ready for Term 4

Name: _____

Start date: _____

PRINT. PRACTISE. ENJOY THE BREAK.

Short, purposeful practice without holiday pressure

Original resource | Australian English | Low-pressure holiday practice

Not an official ACARA or NAPLAN publication



Welcome, grown-ups!

Parent guide + 5-day plan

How to use this pack

Choose one short session each day. Read the directions together, then let your child try independently. Help with reading if needed, but avoid turning the activity into a test. Stop after 20 minutes, even if a page is unfinished.

Helpful parent script

"Show me what you notice first. Which part can you try on your own? If you get stuck, we will solve one step together."

Five-day plan

☐	Day 1	Read and think	Pages 3-4
☐	Day 2	Build better sentences	Page 5
☐	Day 3	Number sense and operations	Pages 6-7
☐	Day 4	Fractions, time and money	Page 8
☐	Day 5	Data, challenge and reflection	Pages 9-10

Support and extension

Support: Read questions aloud, use counters or draw a picture. Extension: Ask your child to explain why an answer makes sense or invent a similar question.

The Surprise in the Garden

On the first morning of the spring holidays, Zara followed a trail of damp footprints across the back verandah. They were too small for a dog and too neat for a bird. The trail ended beside a cracked flowerpot. Zara crouched quietly. A blue-tongue lizard blinked from beneath the pot, warming itself in a patch of sunlight. Zara wanted to call her brother, but she remembered that sudden noise might frighten the visitor. Instead, she backed away and drew a quick sign: PLEASE WALK QUIETLY. Later, Zara and her brother placed a shallow dish of water nearby and watched from the kitchen window. The lizard stayed for ten minutes, then disappeared under the rosemary bush. Zara recorded the sighting in her holiday journal. She had planned a lazy morning, but nature had given her a mystery to solve.

Answer in complete sentences

1. Where did the footprints end?

2. Why did Zara avoid calling out?

3. What two things did the children do to help or protect the lizard?

4. What does the word sighting mean in this passage?

5. What does the story show about Zara's character? Use evidence.

Day 1 - Word detective

English - Vocabulary and comprehension

A. Match each word to its meaning

- | | |
|--------------|-------------------|
| 1. crouched | A. went backwards |
| 2. frighten | B. bent low |
| 3. recorded | C. make afraid |
| 4. retreated | D. wrote down |

B. Choose a stronger verb

The lizard went under the bush. *slid / wandered / vanished*

Rewrite: _____

Zara looked at the footprints. *glanced / examined / stared*

Rewrite: _____

Her brother came to the window. *rushed / shuffled / skipped*

Rewrite: _____

C. Put the events in order (1-4)

- [] Zara made a quiet sign.
- [] The lizard disappeared.
- [] Zara noticed footprints.
- [] The children watched from the window.

D. Think deeper

Was the shallow water dish a sensible choice? Explain your thinking in two sentences.

Day 2 - Build a vivid paragraph

English - Writing

Learning intention

I can organise a paragraph and use precise verbs, sensory details and varied sentence beginnings.

1. Upgrade the sentences

The bird went across the grass.

The flowers were nice.

I saw an insect.

2. Plan: A surprising spring discovery

Where were you?

What did you notice?

What happened next?

How did you feel?

3. Write one strong paragraph

Try: Suddenly... At first... Without warning... A moment later...

Quick edit:

☐

capital letters

☐

end punctuation

☐

precise verb

☐

sensory detail

Day 3 - Number sense

Maths - Place value and patterns

A. Place value

1. Write 4,306 in expanded form: _____
2. What is the value of the 7 in 7,842? _____
3. Make the largest number using 2, 5, 0 and 8 once each: _____
4. Order from smallest to largest: 2,905 2,590 2,950 2,509

B. Continue each pattern

- 125, 150, 175, _____, _____
- 940, 890, 840, _____, _____
- 7, 14, 21, _____, _____
- 2,005, 2,105, 2,205, _____, _____

C. Estimate, then solve

- | | | |
|-------------|-----------------|--------------|
| $287 + 146$ | Estimate: _____ | Exact: _____ |
| $704 - 268$ | Estimate: _____ | Exact: _____ |
| $398 + 205$ | Estimate: _____ | Exact: _____ |

Challenge

I am a four-digit number. My thousands digit is 3. My hundreds digit is double my ones digit. My tens digit is 0. My digits total 9. What number am I?

Day 3 - Operation detective

Maths - Add, subtract, multiply and divide

A. Calculate

$36 + 47 =$

$92 - 58 =$

$6 \times 7 =$

$48 \div 6 =$

$235 + 189 =$

$600 - 274 =$

B. Solve the holiday problems

1. Mia collected 128 leaves on Monday and 157 on Tuesday. How many altogether?

2. A wildlife park had 450 visitors. By noon, 186 had left. How many remained?

3. Six picnic tables each seat 8 people. How many people can sit altogether?

4. Forty-two strawberries are shared equally among 7 children. How many each?

C. Explain your strategy

Choose one problem. Show or describe how you checked that your answer was reasonable.

Day 4 - Real-life maths

Maths - Fractions, time and money

A. Fractions

1. Shade $\frac{3}{4}$ of this strip:

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2. Circle the larger fraction: $\frac{1}{2}$ or $\frac{1}{4}$

3. Complete: Two quarters = _____ half.

4. A pizza has 8 equal slices. Leo eats 2. What fraction did he eat?

B. Time

The movie starts at 10:35 am and lasts 50 minutes. It ends at _____.

A walk begins at 2:15 pm and finishes at 3:05 pm. It lasts _____ minutes.

Write quarter to nine in digital time: _____.

C. Australian money

A notebook costs \$4.75 and a pen costs \$2.40. Total: \$_____

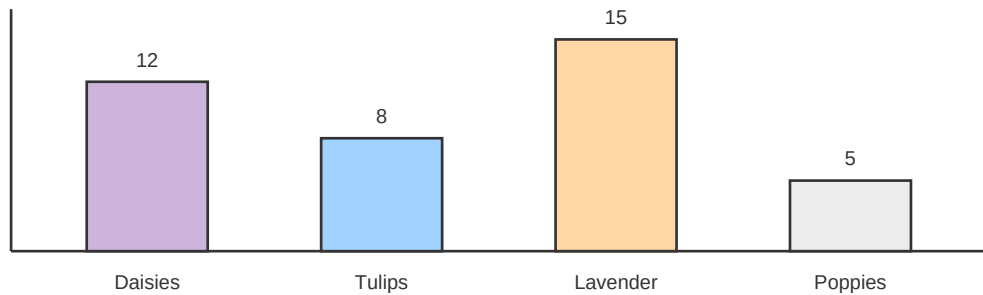
You pay \$10 for an item costing \$6.65. Change: \$_____

Which is cheaper: three \$2 drinks or one \$5.50 jug? Difference: \$_____

Extension

Create a \$12 picnic using at least three items: apples \$2.50, rolls \$3.20, cheese \$4.80, juice \$2.90, berries \$3.60. You may buy an item more than once.

A. Flowers counted in a community garden



1. How many flowers were counted altogether? _____
2. How many more lavender plants than poppies? _____
3. If 4 more tulips bloom, how many tulips will there be? _____
4. Write one true statement comparing two categories.

B. Design a mini garden

A rectangular garden bed is 6 m long and 3 m wide. Find its perimeter. Then sketch a plan showing four equal sections and label what you would plant.

Perimeter: _____

Finish strong!

Mixed challenge + reflection

Spring code-breaker

Solve each question. Match each answer to the code table to reveal a word.

Code: 18 = B 24 = L 36 = O 42 = O 56 = M

A. $3 \times 6 =$ _____

B. $30 - 6 =$ _____

C. $6 \times 6 =$ _____

D. $7 \times 6 =$ _____

E. $7 \times 8 =$ _____

Secret spring word: _____

Mini review

1. Correct the sentence: on monday we seen three bright butterflys

2. Write a synonym for happy: _____

3. $425 + 176 =$ _____

4. $\frac{3}{4}$ of 12 = _____

5. A book costs \$8.50. Change from \$20 = \$_____

My reflection

☐ I read carefully.

☐ I showed my maths thinking.

☐ I checked punctuation.

☐ I asked for help when I needed it.

One thing I feel more confident about:

One goal for Term 4:

Page 3 - Reading

1. The footprints ended beside a cracked flowerpot.
2. Zara thought sudden noise might frighten the lizard.
3. They placed a shallow dish of water nearby and watched quietly from inside.
4. A sighting is seeing or noticing an animal or object.
5. Sample: Zara is careful and considerate. She stayed quiet, made a sign and watched without disturbing the lizard.

Page 4 - Vocabulary

A: 1-B, 2-C, 3-D, 4-A. B: Accept suitable stronger verbs used correctly. C order: Zara noticed footprints (1); Zara made a sign (2); the children watched (3); the lizard disappeared (4). D: Accept a supported opinion; a shallow, stable dish can provide water without trapping the lizard.

Page 5 - Writing

Answers will vary. Look for one organised paragraph with a clear discovery, logical sequence, correct sentence punctuation, a precise verb and at least one sensory detail.

Sample paragraph

Without warning, a tiny green frog sprang from the wet grass beside my shoe. At first, I froze and listened to its soft croak. The frog crouched beneath a silver leaf while raindrops tapped the path. A moment later, it vanished into the garden bed, leaving me excited and curious.

Page 6 - Number sense

A: 1. $4,000 + 300 + 6$; 2. 7,000; 3. 8,520; 4. 2,509, 2,590, 2,905, 2,950. B: 200, 225; 790, 740; 28, 35; 2,305, 2,405. C exact: 433; 436; 603. Estimates vary if reasonable. Challenge: 3,402.

Page 7 - Operations

A: 83; 34; 42; 8; 424; 326. B: 285 leaves; 264 visitors; 48 people; 6 strawberries each. C: Accept a correct checking strategy, such as inverse operation, estimation or repeated addition.

Page 8 - Real-life maths

A: shade three of four equal parts; $\frac{1}{2}$; one; $\frac{2}{8}$ or $\frac{1}{4}$. B: 11:25 am; 50 minutes; 8:45. C: \$7.15; \$3.35; the \$5.50 jug is cheaper by \$0.50. Extension answers vary; total must be no more than \$12 and include at least three items.

Page 9 - Data and measurement

A: 40 flowers; 10 more; 12 tulips; comparison statement varies. B: Perimeter = 18 m. The plan should show four equal sections with labels.

Page 10 - Mixed challenge

Code-breaker: BLOOM. Mini review: 1. On Monday, we saw three bright butterflies. 2. Answers may include glad, joyful or cheerful. 3. 601. 4. 9. 5. \$11.50.

A note for adults

Use mistakes as information. If a skill feels difficult, return to one worked example rather than adding more pages. The aim is confidence and continuity, not holiday testing.